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but it is viewed to be associated with water absorption, secretion and prevent dessication of shoot. The members belonging to Homeophyllum type possess same type of leaves spirally arranged on the stem whereas the Heterophyllum type have two types of leaves- two dorsal rows of small leaves(Microphylls) and two ventral rows of large leaves(Megaphylls).

Internal structure

Root

The transverse section of the root reveals an outermost layer called epidermis. It is made up of tangentially elongated cells. The cortex is homogeneous made up of thin walled parenchyma . The innermost layer of cortex is called endodermis. The stele is a protostele, monarch and xylem is exarch (Figure 2.26).

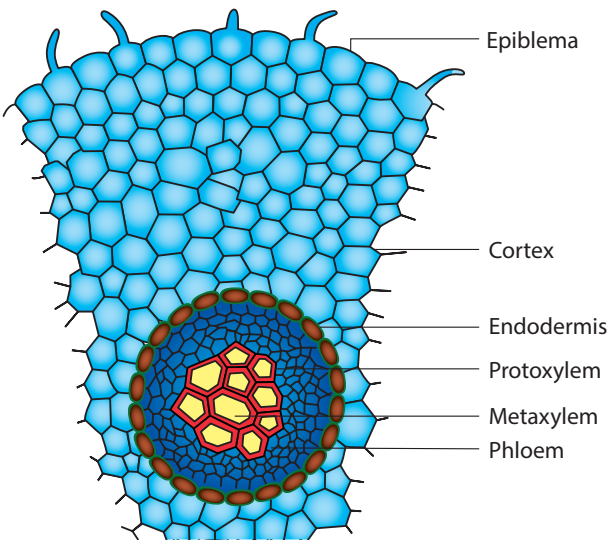


Figure 2.26: T.S. of root

Rhizophore

The outermost layer of Rhizophore is the epidermis. It is single layered and is covered with a thick cuticle. The cortex is differentiated into outer scelrenchymatous and inner parenchymatous layers. The innermost layer of cortex forms endodermis. The stele is a protostele Figure 2.37. It is monarch and exarch but it is centrifugal in *S. kraussiana* and crescent shaped in *S. atroviridis*.

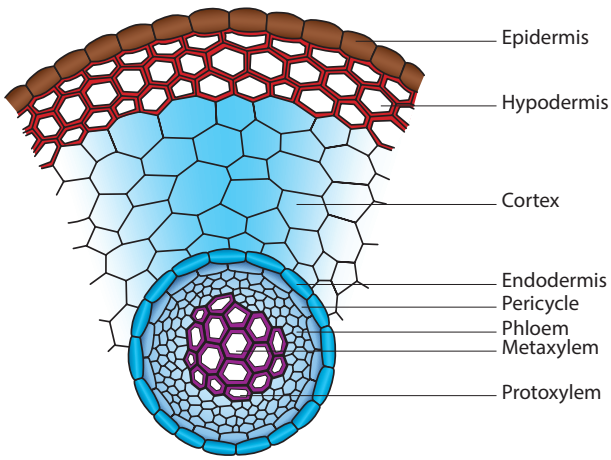


Figure 2.27: T.S. of Rhizophore

Stem

The anatomy of the stem reveals the presence of epidermis, cortex and stelar region (Figure 2.28).

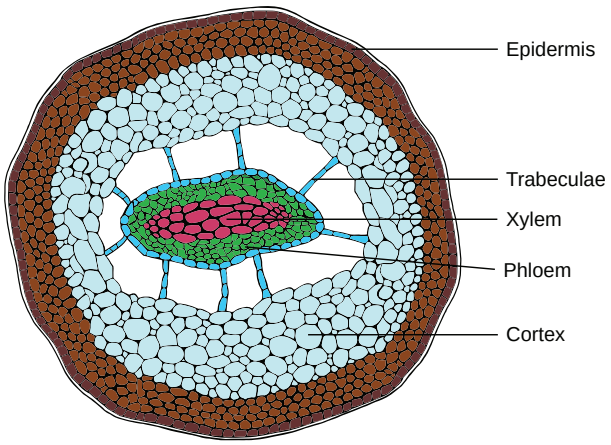


Figure 2.28: T.S. of Stem

The epidermis is parenchymatous and is covered with a thick cuticle. The cortex is parenchymatous with cells arranged without intercellular spaces. A sclerenchymatous hypodermis is noticed in *Selaginella lepidophylla*. The presence of radially elongated endodermal cells